Freedom Under the Etherian Skies: Act II

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/73289936.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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F/M

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Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra), Entrapta & Hordak (She-Ra), Hordak & Wrong Hordak (She-Ra), Entrapta & Glimmer (She-Ra)

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by yourfellowhuman

Summary

With their enemies captured, the Alliance returns to their kingdoms while awaiting Hordak's trial.

Notes

FUTES has finally returned with Act Two!
I'm super excited to finally continue this series, so thank you so much for reading!

See the end of the work for more notes

The light from the mid-afternoon moons poured through the windows of Queen Angell- Queen Glimmer's office. Glimmer sat at her desk with her head in her hands, her mind still swirling from last night.

After she had officially announced the end of the war, the refugees and the Alliance had thrown together a celebration. They played music on whatever instruments they could find and broke into the hidden drink reserves in the castle. They had partied into the long hours of the night, many others still fast asleep so far into the day.

Glimmer, of course, also had her fun, but she still had many things weighing on her mind and hope in her heart.

After fixing up the Spire, Entrapta had informed Glimmer of Hordak's hand in defeating Horde Prime and saving her life in the process, which shocked the queen. Entrapta now felt indebted to him and urged Glimmer to give him a lighter sentence. A part of this sentence included Hordak helping Entrapta with a new project of hers that filled Glimmer with hope.

Entrapta theorized that with the right calculations, the two could open a portal that could access the space between the wider universe and Despondos, saving Angella in the process.

When Glimmer heard this, she nearly fainted. She had been so certain that she would never see her mother again, so hearing this from Entrapta was a shock to say the least.

Glimmer quickly urged Entrapta not to speak a word of this to anyone, especially her dad. She couldn't bear the thought of getting his hopes up.

There was also the announcement she made last night. She kept replaying her words over and over again, scrutinizing every syllable until her head pounded. She was in such a rush to get it out that she didn't even mention the clones, which brought on a whole other migraine. How in the world could she tell millions of

devoted clones that their entire way of life was shattered, and how would they accept the Alliance's help?

Then two light taps on the door broke Glimmer's spiral.

"Come in," the queen shouted.

An elk-like person walked through the door. They begged their majesty's pardon and offered them tea and told them lunch would be served within the hour. The queen happily accepted it with a wry smile, and the person quickly took their leave.

As Glimmer sipped her tea, she let her mind settle. She stood up to look out the floor-to-ceiling windows behind the desk. She looked out at the vast Whispering Woods, and she once again furrowed her brow at the sight of Horde Prime's spires.

'One thing at a time, Glimmer.'

Suddenly, the door creaked open, and Glimmer turned around to see Entrapta at the door. She had raised herself on her hair and had a bag slung over her shoulder.

"I thought I should leave," Entrapta began hesitantly, "since everyone else already has."

"Good," Glimmer blurted. She set the cup down on her desk. "That sounds good." Glimmer stepped around the desk, and Entrapta fully entered the room.

"After I check up on my kingdom, I can start running some numbers, and see if our," Entrapta paused, "project is possible."

"Perfect," Glimmer said hopefully. "I'm really grateful that you're doing this, Entrapta."

"Any excuse to do science," said enthusiastically, "I'm happy to continue my studies on portals. I've done so much work on them, but it still feels like I know nothing!" Entrapta paused when Glimmer's expression shifted. She took a moment to analyze her

features and hypothesized that she was not satisfied. “But I am happy to help you and your mom.”

Glimmer’s face shifted to a more pleasant expression that calmed Entrata down.

“Just make sure not to tell anyone.”

“Can do!” Entrapta pulled her recorder from her hair. She clicked a button, and the device repeated what Glimmer had said about the issue the night before. At that, Glimmer could only give Entrapta a pained smile.

Emily then poked through the door and beeped with impatience.

“I’m coming, Emily! Bye, Glimmer,” Entrapta exclaimed, already bounding down the hallway.

“Bye, Entrapta,” Glimmer tried to reply, but Entrapta was already too far away.

Glimmer turned back toward her desk, ready to put her mind to something else, but she stopped when she heard Entrapta call out to Wro- TD.

Glimmer rushed to look down the hall to see Entrapta and TD waving goodbye to each other.

“TD,” Glimmer exclaimed and teleported right next to him. Before he could even open his mouth, she teleported both of them into her office.

“Glad I could find you.” Glimmer sat at her desk.

“Of course,” TD cleared his throat, still not completely used to Glimmer’s magic. “Your majesty.”

“I have a request for you,” Glimmer said, fingers laced together. “Well, it’s more of a job, actually, but you can totally back out if you want.”

“I would love to assist you in any way.” TD also was desperate for something to do, since most of the refugees barely even make eye contact with him, let alone ask for his help.

“Great,” With a flick of her wrist, she used a rune to move a chair close to TD, the piece of furniture hitting him in the back of the legs. “Oh, sorry. Anyways, you know how you’ve helped us take care of our prisoner Hordak, right?”

“Yes,” he drawled, sitting down.

“Well, I was thinking that it could be a more permanent arrangement.”

“Permanent?”

“Not permanent-permanent,” she tried to clarify, “but for the foreseeable future.”

“Oh.” TD’s face fell slightly.

“All you would need to do is give him his meals and check on him periodically,” Glimmer explained. “Then you have the rest of the day to do whatever you want.”

There was a short, yet poignant, pause.

“I suppose I could do that,” TD said slowly with a strained smile that didn’t meet his eyes..

“Thank you,” Glimmer said with a sigh of relief. She then looked up to TD, who was glancing around the room. “Look, I know it isn’t ideal, but with Adora and Bow leaving for the Crimson Waste and the rest of the Alliance managing their kingdoms….”

“You need someone who can look after the prisoner,” TD interjected.

“And,” Glimmer continued, trying to sound encouraging, “you are the best for the job.”

“Really.”

“Yes,” Glimmer assured, “everyone else is terrified of the guy, and you are the only person who could hold your own if he gets hostile.”

“I understand.”

“Good.”

There was a moment of silence between the two. Glimmer was about to dismiss the clone until he spoke up.

“Glimmer.”

“Yes.”

“Why did you not address the clones like you said you would?”

“I-” she hesitated, “I just didn’t know what to say. How could I tell an entire race of people that their entire way of life is destroyed, so they better join our side or else?” Glimmer’s head once again fell upon her hands.

“Tell it to their faces.”

“Huh?” Glimmer said as she looked up, not expecting TD to actually answer.

“Many of them may have questions, so telling them over Prime’s holograms would not work,” he explained. “If you tell them in person, you could properly explain their situation and make them understand more clearly.”

“You might be right,” the queen mused. “But, how could we get all of them together? There are thousands of them.”

“We could set up areas around Etheria for the various meetings to take place,” he suggested.

“We could set them up at the spires,” Glimmer exclaimed. “That way they know where they are.”

“Yes!”

For the next half hour, Glimmer and TD discussed the intricacies of their plan. Who would be helping, what materials they would need, and picking the best locations. While Glimmer was feeling more relieved, TD was filled with a sense of purpose. He had initially only thought of teaching the handful of clones he knew in his past the wonders of freedom, but as he and Glimmer laid out their plans, he thought of every single last clone and how he wanted to help them.

Help them find themselves.

Help them see the beauty of Etheria and the wider universe.

Help them realize their potential outside of Horde Prime’s cold, dead light.

As the overwhelming sense of purpose filled his veins, it ignited a fire of determination in his soul. He will help his brothers, no matter how hard they cling to their older brother’s doctrine.

“Excuse me, your majesty,” a voice squeaked. The queen and the clone looked toward the door to see the same elk-like person from before. “Lunch is ready for everyone.”

Glimmer then looked toward TD, and the clone sighed. He had almost forgotten his job.

TD did not exactly know what to make of Hordak.

He was terrifying. Just the thought of a clone landing on a peaceful planet and singlehandedly creating a 30-year-long war on the peaceful planet of Etheria was enough to send shivers through TD’s circuits.

Yet, that was all he was: a clone. A very angry clone, but a clone nonetheless. A clone that TD found to be easily hateable. Whenever he overheard a story about the havoc he and his armies brought, it made his stomach churn. Why could he never see the error of his ways, or that Horde Prime was not worth the effort of taking over an entire planet for? Thirty years that clone wasted, and for what? Yes, the clone was brought back to Horde Prime, but how in his thirty years could he not see the beauty of this planet! How could he be so ignorant!

Still, what did it matter? Horde Prime was gone, and Hordak's Horde had been scattered to the four winds. Now, all the clone could do was await his judgment.

Yet, and this was a thought TD tried not to pay attention to, when face-to-face with the clone, TD could not bring himself to outright despise him.

Sure, when faced with him, TD still recognized the clone's sins, but something was preventing him from hating him whenever he was around him. Perhaps it was the simple fact that he was a clone. A brother. A familiar face from his previous life as an acolyte of Horde Prime.

Yes, that had to be it….

Right?

Hordak watched out of one of the large windows in his room as Entrapta left the palace of Brightmoon out of the front gate.

He felt a strange mix of relief and dread as he watched her figure grow smaller and smaller as she walked away.

He was content to see her leave, since it was less likely their secret would be found out, meaning her standing with the Alliance would not be in jeopardy.

Yet, seeing her leave made him worry. Now, there was not a single soul in the palace he could reasonably rely on.

He was alone, up against people who would happily see him dead.

Still, it was better this way. Entrapta would know he was safe in Brightmoon, and she can carry on with attending to her kingdom as he awaits his trial, however long that may be.

When Entrapta had left his sight, a knock on the door alerted Hordak. He stood up straighter, his hands tucked behind his back, and did his best to school his face into a neutral expression.

The magical barrier coating the room opened with the door. TD entered the room like he did the night before.

“Lunch,” he said. “For you,” he added. TD set the tray on a nearby table. He seemed cold and distant, clearly wanting to be anywhere else.

“Thank you,” Hordak muttered, trying to keep an even tone, but he almost sounded annoyed.

“Of course,” TD said absentmindedly. He then quickly exited the room, leaving Hordak, once again, alone.

Hordak, having no appetite, turned around to stare out the window, his mind lingering on both his love and his brother.

End Notes

Thank you so much for reading this, and make sure to drop a comment!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!